

25CV-00325

Mohammed Yahya vs Javier Maldonado, et al.

Motion to Tax Costs

The motion to tax costs is DENIED.

The filing, motion, jury fees, and deposition costs are expressly allowed and are reasonable. Although the conference room reservation costs are not expressly allowed, they are not expressly disallowed. After a review of the record, the Court in its discretion finds the conference room reservation costs were reasonably necessary and are reasonable in amount.

Accordingly, Defendant is awarded costs in the amount of \$2,605.00.

25CV-05975

Jose Valencia vs General Motors LLC

Order to Show Cause Re: Dismissal – Notice of Settlement

Appearance required. Appear to address the status of the conditional settlement for which notice was filed June 4, 2026, with an anticipated dismissal date of July 18, 2026, and show cause why the Court should not dismiss the matter, retaining jurisdiction for enforcement purposes pursuant to Code of Civil Procedure section 664.6. If there are no appearances, the matter may be dismissed by the Court pursuant to the settlement under California Rules of Court, rule 3.1385, as more than 45 days have passed since the date the settlement agreement conditions were to be completed.

25CV-06365

Michael Rocha vs Ford Motor Company, et al.

Status Conference

Appearance required. Appear to address status of arbitration ordered March 2, 2026.

26CV-00547

Joe Scoto vs Philip Snowberger

Motion for Attorney's Fees

The motion for attorney fees is GRANTED.

Plaintiff seeks to set the lodestar at \$25,549.50.

The amount of attorney's fees awarded is a matter within the court's discretion. (*Clayton Development Co. v. Falvey* (1988) 206 Cal.App.3d 438, 447.)

The court begins its assessment with a lodestar figure. Lodestar refers to the “number of hours reasonably expended multiplied by the reasonable hourly rate” of an attorney. (*PLCM Group, Inc. v. Drexler* (2000) 22 Cal.4th 1084, 1096.)

The reasonable hourly rate is that prevailing in the community for similar work. (*PLCM Group v. Drexler* (2000) 22 Cal.4th 1084, 1095.) The rate is measured in the market place, and reflects several factors: the level of skill necessary, time limitations, the amount to be obtained in the litigation, the attorney's reputation, and the undesirability of the case. (*Shaffer v. Superior Court* (1995) 33 Cal.App.4th 993, 1002.)

Plaintiff's counsel claims an hourly rate of \$460 for attorney Kimberly Flores, \$350 for attorney Yao Vang, and \$245 for paralegal Tim Kolb.

The Court finds the claimed hourly rates for the attorneys, while high for the local area, are within the range of rates charged in the local Merced community for the same or similar work. However, the claimed paralegal hourly rate is not representative of the rates charged in the local community. Accordingly, the Court finds it reasonable to set the hourly rate of paralegal Kolb at \$150 /hour.

A trial court may not rubberstamp a request for attorney fees, and must determine the number of hours reasonably expended. (*Donahue v. Donahue* (2010) 182 Cal.App.4th 259, 271.)

After a substantial review of the entire record and the documents offered in support of Plaintiff's motion, the court finds the time billed is excessive and finds it reasonable to reduce the hours billed. The court finds it reasonable to reduce the total time for attorney Flores by 1.6 hours, attorney Vang by 13.8 hours, and paralegal Kolb by 2.8 hours.

This results in a lodestar of \$20,444. This represents the reasonable total billed time for attorney Flores of 15.9 hours at \$460 an hour, for attorney Vang of 31.9 hours at \$350 an hour, and paralegal Kolb at 13.1 hours at \$150 an hour.

Accordingly, the Court awards attorney fees in favor of Plaintiff in the amount of \$20,444.

Attorney fees are to be paid within thirty (30) days of this Court's order.

26CV-00661

Renee Haney vs Pacific Coast Services, Inc., et al.

Motion for Final Approval

The motion for final approval of class action settlement is **GRANTED**. The hearing on the final accounting is set for June 16, 2027, at 8:15 a.m. in Courtroom 8.

The Court has already granted preliminary approval of the settlement, including finding that the amount of the settlement is fair, adequate and reasonable. Nothing has occurred since that order that would change this Court's determination.

The Court will sign the proposed order lodged with the court on August 20, 2026.

26CV-02880

Richard Howard vs Merced Community College District, et al.

Demurrer to Plaintiff's Complaint